

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(STANDARD GK)

INDIA & THE WORLD

MODULE – 22

UPSC / GR 1

IBPS / SSC

GENERAL

RAMSAR SITES ... PART - 2



- Brijghat to Narora Stretch.
- It is shallow river stretch of Great Ganges.
- Habitat for IUCN Red-listed Ganges River Dolphin, Gharial, Crocodile, Turtles etc.
- Home for medicinal plants.
- High Hindu religious importance.

Threats : Sewage discharge, agricultural runoff, intensive fishing.

Upper Ganga River



Bhoj Wetland



- Two contiguous man-made reservoirs - the "Upper Lake" was created in 11th century with earthen dam across Kolans River and the lower one around 200 years ago, surrounded by city of Bhopal.
- Rich in biodiversity, particularly macrophytes, phytoplankton, zooplankton etc.
- Management Action Plan was implemented since 1995, with financial support from Japan.
- A number of bird species were seen because of the above efforts.

Arabian Sea

- It is the large saline lake fed by four streams set in a shallow wetland surrounded by sand flats.
- Important for a variety of wintering water birds, including large number of flamingos.



Threats : Human activities, which include salt production and livestock grazing.

Sambhar Lake



Rajasthan

Haryana

NEPAL

BHUTAN

Assam

Uttar Pradesh

Gujarat

Madhya Pradesh

INDIA

Nalsarovar

- Natural freshwater lake in the Thar Desert Biogeographic Province.
- It is a Wildlife Sanctuary.
- Important stopover site within the Central Asia Flyway.
- Lifeline for a satellite population of the endangered Indian Wild Ass during dry season.
- Provides drinking water and water for irrigation.
- Important source of income for fishing communities.

Arabian Sea



Keoladeo National Park



- It is in Montreux Record since 1990.
- It is World Heritage Site, National Park, Bird Sanctuary.
- Consists of ten artificial, seasonal lagoons.
- Vegetation as a mosaic of scrub and open grassland that provides habitat for breeding, wintering and staging migratory birds.

Threats : Water shortage, unbalanced grazing regime, invasive growth of the grass *paspalum distichum*.

Tamil Nadu

- It is the largest brackish, humid tropical ecosystem on the southwest coast, covering 2.5% of the geographical area of Kerala.
- Includes Vembanad Lake, Kuttanadu marshy areas and Kol wetlands.
- Ten rivers feed this wetland including Periyar, Pamba etc.
- Supports third largest waterfowl population during winter.
- Flood protection/groundwater recharge are the main facets.
- Valuable for the local transport of people and trade.



Vembanad-kol Wetland

- Largest freshwater lake in Kerala.
- Spring-fed and the source of drinking water for half a million people in the Kollam district.
- Water contains no common salts or other minerals and supports no water plants.
- A larva called "cavaborus" is plenty and it eliminates bacteria in the water and hence gives exceptional purity to the water.
- Ancient Sastha temple is important pilgrimage centre here.

Sasthamkotta Lake



- It is an extensive estuarine system, second largest in Kerala.
- Supports number of mangrove species.
- Known for its houseboat and backwater resorts.
- Thousands of fishermen depends on it.

Threats : Population density and urban pressures,
pollution from oil spills/ pollution from industries.

Ashtamudi Wetland



- Natural eutrophic lake, situated between Godavari and Krishna rivers and also acts as natural flood balancing between these two Deltas.
- Provides habitat for a number of resident and migratory birds, including declining numbers of the vulnerable Grey Pelican (*Pelecanus philippensis*).
- Sustains both culture and capture fisheries, agriculture and related occupations of the people.



Threats : Damage and losses due to flooding in monsoon seasons and partial drying in summers, inadequate management planning and action.

Kolleru Lake

Andhra Pradesh

KARNATAKA

Tamil Nadu

KERALA



Point Calimere Wildlife And Bird Sanctuary

- It consists of shallow waters, shores, long sand bars, intertidal forests, mangroves, saline lagoons etc.
- Breeding ground for many commercially important species of fish/prawns/crabs.
- Vulnerable species Spoonbill Sandpiper and Grey Pelican are found.
- Visitors come to the site both for recreation and for pilgrimage, as it is associated with Lord Rama.

Threats : Illegal collection of firewood / spread of *Prosopis Chilensis* (Chilean mesquite), increasingly brackish groundwater, decreasing inflow of freshwater.

- World famous for resource recovery systems.
- Because of them, Calcutta is called Ecologically Subsidized City.
- It treats the city's waste water and utilizes the treated water for pisciculture and agriculture, through the recovery of nutrients in an efficient manner.
- Water flows through fish ponds, which act as solar reactors, completing most of their bio-chemical reactions.

Threats : Unauthorized use of the waste water outfall channels by industries, which threatens the edible quality of the fish and vegetables.

East Calcutta Wetlands

- The largest coastal lagoon in India at the mouth of Daya River.
- Brackish lake separated from the Bay of Bengal by a long sandy ridge.
- Extreme seasonal variations in salinity.
- Saline areas support aquatic algae.
- Important area for breeding, wintering and staging for 33 species of waterbirds.
- Entered in Montreux Record in 1993 and removed in 2002, because of rehabilitation efforts.

Chilika Lake

Bhitarkanika Mangroves

- One of the finest mangroves due to continued conservation efforts.
- Gahirmatha beach is host to largest known Olive Ridley Sea Turtle nesting.
- Highest density of saltwater crocodile, with nearly 700 *Crocodylus porosus*.
- Dhamra Port is situated nearer to it.
- Major breeding and wintering place for many migratory waterbirds.
- Major nursery for brackish water and estuarine fish fauna.
- Of 58 recorded species of mangroves, 55 are found in Bhitarkanika.
- They provide vital protection for millions from devastating cyclones and tidal surges.

Threats : Population pressures / encroachments threaten the equilibrium.



- Permanent freshwater lake.
- Former channel of Brahmaputra river.
- Only major storm water storage basin for Guwahati.
- Staging site for several migratory flyways.

Threats : Over-fishing and hunting pressure upon water birds, pollution from pesticides & fertilizers and infestation by water hyacinth *Elchhornia crassipes*. A proposal to create a sewage canal from the city directly to the beel is considered to be disastrous.



Deepor Beel

- It is in Montreux Record, added in 1993.
- It is shrinking freshwater lake characterised by Phumdis, which are floating mats of weeds covered with soil.
- Local people use it as a source of water for irrigation and domestic use.
- Plays important role in flood control.
- Construction of dam for hydroelectric power generation and irrigation caused local extinction of several fish species.

Threats: Deforestation in the catchment area, infestation of water hyacinth and pollution.



Loktak Lake

Rudrasagar Lake

- Fed by three perennial streams discharging to River Gomti.
- Low-land sedimentation reservoir known for important commercial freshwater fishes.
- Ideal habitat for IUCN Redlisted Three-striped Roof Turtle *Kachuga dhongka*.
- Heavy rainfall of 2,500mm.
- Assists in groundwater recharge.
- Lands leased out to subsistent fishermen's cooperative.
- Attracts huge devotees during Vijayadashami.

Threats : Increasing silt loads due to deforestation, expansion of agricultural land and intensive farming, land conversion due to population pressure.



WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao
K. Srikanth
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu
M. Binukrishna
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9